SAIKUMAR CHINTADA

Backend & Data Platform Engineer | Tech Lead | NIT Calicut

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Summary

Backend and data platform engineer with 8+ years, including 3 as Tech Lead. Builds distributed services and orchestration systems in Golang and Python — an open-source platform scheduling 5000+ DAGs, 70% batch compute savings, a zero-downtime TB-scale migration. Depth in event-driven microservices, Postgres, Airflow, Trino, Kubernetes.

Skills

Languages: Golang, Python, SQL, JavaScript
Data Platform: Airflow, Trino, Hive, DBT, ETL/Reverse ETL, Semantic Layer
Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP, Hetzner, Git
Databases: Postgres, MongoDB, Redis

Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Sundial, Bangalore — Nov 2025 – Mar 2026

- Built an on-demand semantic layer for exploratory analytics over base tables, with a query layer translating metric queries into table queries (Python, Golang, Trino, Kubernetes, Redis).
- Diagnosed and led resolution of a critical concurrency bug in a custom pipeline orchestrator that had caused silent SLA misses for months.

Freelance Consultant | Early-Stage Startup, Remote — Jan 2024 – Oct 2025

- Prototyped checkpointing with intent-based speculative scaling, cutting user-facing job latency from 20 minutes to 1 minute.
- Built a cost-efficient k3s-based load testing platform on Hetzner Cloud.

Tech Lead, Data Platform | Gojek, Bangalore — Mar 2022 – Jan 2024

- Led development of an open-source job specification and orchestration layer (Optimus) scheduling 5000+ DAGs for BigQuery ingestion, egress and transformation.
- Cut the release cycle from 3 days to 1 hour by simplifying the plugin system and execution model; added YAML-based plugins and deprecated 90% of legacy plugins.
- Upgraded legacy Airflow clusters, reducing Airflow DB CPU usage by 80% and lowering scheduling lag.
- Achieved 70% cost reduction on batch workloads by fixing issues that blocked Kubernetes node pool scale-down.

Tech Lead, Data Platform | JioSaavn, Bangalore — Jan 2020 – Mar 2022

- Built a centrally governed Reverse ETL service and migrated 50+ ad-hoc pipelines onto it, enabling non-technical analysts to run push, email and ad campaigns.
- Orchestrated a zero-downtime MongoDB migration (12 shards, 36 nodes, TB-scale) from AWS to Azure; achieved 10x faster shard operations with a custom chunk migration solution.
- Reduced MongoDB cluster size 33% through selective archiving, deletion and downscaling.
- Led Kubernetes adoption by migrating production VM-based Trino and Airflow clusters to Kubernetes.

Software Engineer | Coverfox, Mumbai — May 2018 – Oct 2019

- Migrated a critical finance module from a monolith to an event-driven microservice (Python, Flask, Django, AWS Lambda, Postgres).
- Reduced offline financial accounting from weeks to hours by onboarding offline policy workflows and unifying the commission payout system.
- Built a custom JSON based testing framework for non-technical QA team and led them to contribute to automated testing in critical finance calculations.

Software Engineer | CouponDunia, Mumbai — Jul 2016 – May 2018

- Owned a full-stack sub-product and browser extension; improved coupon auto-apply time at checkout from 30s to 2s.

Education

National Institute of Technology Calicut | B.Tech, Computer Science | CGPA 7.65 — 2016

Independent R&D

- Apr 2026 – Present: prototyping meeting-driven development (specs derived from meeting transcripts) and an agentic SDLC workflow using hexagonal architecture grounded in a domain ontology (github.com/smarchone/skills).